

ECON 101—INTRODUCTION TO MICROECONOMICS

Fall 2019

Department of Economics
Nazarbayev University

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Lecture time/Location: MW, 11:30 AM–12:45 PM, Green Hall.

Office hours: MW 2:00 PM–3:00 PM or by appointment.

Tutorial Sessions: There will be tutorial sessions held approximately every other week. Each student should be enrolled in one of the following sections:

1. Friday, 01:00 PM–01:50 PM, 8.307
2. Friday, 02:00 PM–02:50 PM, 8.307
3. Friday, 04:00 PM–04:50 PM, 8.327
4. Friday, 05:00 PM–05:50 PM, 8.307

Course Description The objective of the course is to introduce you to a set of analytical tools, i.e. *the core principles of microeconomics*, needed to understand the functioning of market economies and also to apply those principles to everyday life and understand economic and social phenomena. At the end of the course, the student is expected to apply these tools in the analysis of daily economic problems and to be able to discuss critically economic policy issues. We will study consumer and firms behavior, how different types of markets work, welfare implications of different market structures, international trade, market failures, and public policies.

Course Website Additional course material, such as lecture slides, quizzes and announcements will be posted on the Moodle page of the course.

Textbook The required textbook is **Microeconomics**, by D. Acemoglu, D. Laibson, J. List. You will be provided with access codes, which you should use to access the e-book version. It is very important that every student uses the access code. You should also be able to find print copies of older versions in the library. You will be responsible for all the material I cover or assign in class. Therefore, studying the textbook is very important but *not* a perfect substitute for the material I cover in class.

Grading Policy Grading will be based upon two midterm exams, a final exam, and Moodle quizzes/assignments, according to the following weights:

- Midterm I (25%)
- Midterm II (25%)
- Final Exam (30%)
- Moodle Assignments (20%)

Exams will be during class time and closed book. I will arrange to have a more comfortable room to take the exams. The arrangements will be communicated later during the course. Midterm exams are not cumulative but the final exam is. The final exam will be during Final's week and the date will be selected by the Registrar.

There will be *weekly* Moodle assignments which you will complete online.

Also, every other week I will post a problem set in Moodle which your TA will go over with you during the tutorials. These problem sets are not graded but is very important that you attempt to solve them. The best way to keep up with the coursework and prepare for the exams is to work on as many problems as you can regularly. Do not expect to do well in this course by only reading the textbook just before the exams.

A letter grade based on the sum of the components above will be assigned as follows:

Letter Grade	Score Achieved
A	[95, 100]
A–	[90, 95)
B+	[85, 90)
B	[80, 85)
B–	[75, 80)
C+	[70, 75)
C	[65, 70)
C–	[60, 65)
D+	[55, 60)
D	[50, 55)
F	[0, 50)

Important Dates Table 1 lists the dates of the Tutorials and the Midterm exams.

Table 1: Important dates		
Important dates: Tutorials and Recitations		
Tutorials/Exam	Dates	Notes
T1	Friday, August 23, 2019	
T2	Friday, September 6, 2019	
T3	Friday, September 20, 2019	
EXAM 1	Monday, September 23, 2019	
T4	Friday, October 11, 2019	
T5	Friday, October 25, 2019	
T6	Friday, November 8, 2019	
EXAM 2	Monday, November 11, 2019	
T7	Friday, November 22, 2019	

Course attendance Attendance is very important and mandatory (school policy). It will be measured throughout the semester but not necessarily in every class. You should expect some randomness in terms of which classes I take attendance. Your attendance will be recorded using a regular attendance sheet or through in-class activities and quizzes. There will be no excuses for missing a class (or a make-up for a quiz or any other in-class activity). You will be recorded as absent if you are late by more than 10 minutes or leave early, use your phone/tablet/laptop, chat with your friends, do work for other classes, or engage in any kind of disruptive behavior.

Make-up Policy You need to have a valid and documented reason (per university policy) for missing an exam. Do your best not to miss an exam. If you have a valid reason for missing a midterm exam, its weight will be shifted to the final exam.

Rules and Regulations Please turn off laptops, tablets, and mobile phones, unless you are asked to do otherwise. Do not arrive late or leave early without prior permission; Do not engage in side conversations or other disruptive behavior.

Academic Misconduct Academic and personal misconduct by any student in this course will be dealt with according to the requirements and procedures in the Student Code of Conduct for Nazarbayev University. Plagiarism and cheating will not be tolerated. Students should be familiar with the university's official statement on plagiarism: Plagiarism is intentionally or carelessly presenting the work of another as one's own. It includes submitting an assignment purporting to be the student's original work which has wholly or in part been created by another person. It also includes the presentation of the work, ideas, representations, or words of another person without customary and proper acknowledgment of sources. Plagiarism occurs when a person:

1. Directly copies one or more sentences of another person's written work without proper citation. If another writer's words are used, you must place quotation marks around the quoted material and include a footnote or other indication of the source of the quotation. This includes cut and paste from the internet or other electronic sources;
2. Changes words but copies the sentence structure of a source without giving credit to the original source, or closely paraphrases one or more paragraphs without acknowledgment of the source of the ideas, or uses graphs, figures, drawings, charts or other visual/audio materials without acknowledging the source or the permission of the author;
3. Submits false or altered information in any academic exercise. This may include making up data for an experiment, altering data, citing nonexistent articles, contriving sources, etc.;
4. Turns in all or part of assignment done by another student and claims it as their own;
5. Uses a paper writing service, has another student write a paper, or uses a foreign language translation and submits it as their own original work.

These are serious offenses resulting in an F grade and disciplinary action.

Tentative Course Outline

1. Introduction: Basic Concepts and Principles.
2. Specialization and Gains from Trade.
3. Demand and Supply.
4. Elasticity of Demand and Supply.
5. Consumer Behavior and Demand.
6. Firm Behavior and Supply in Perfectly Competitive Markets,
7. Long-Run Equilibrium in Perfectly Competitive Markets.
8. Efficiency and Intervention and Markets.
9. Imperfect Competition.
10. Externalities.
11. Public Goods.
12. Game Theory.
13. Economics of Information.

Disclaimer Subsequent changes can be made to any part of this syllabus when necessary. Any changes will be announced in class and on Moodle.